

THE MOTOWN UNIVERSE

Executive Development Memo #017 — Phase 2, Film 2: Release Date & Full Film Sheet

CONFIDENTIAL • An alternate-reality “what if” • Fidelity Rating: 100% • Nerf Tolerance: 0%

TROUBLE MAN

LEAD: Marvin Gaye • RELEASE: Friday, November 7, 2014

Phase 2, Film 2 • The Thor: The Dark World role • Motown Productions / Paramount •

PG-13 • approx. 155 min

A. Release Date: Friday, November 7, 2014

Thor: The Dark World opened on Friday, November 8, 2013. Exactly 52 weeks later is **Friday, November 7, 2014**, the TMU's first fall release.

B. The Thor: The Dark World Blueprint Map

Thor: The Dark World	Trouble Man (documented history)
The prince returns in a darker story	After <i>What's Going On</i> , Marvin's 1970s turn darker
A dark force spreading (the Dark Elves)	Cocaine, debt and tax trouble
The royal family breaks apart	His divorce from Anna Gordy, sister of the king of Motown
The Aether handed to the Collector	The settlement gives Anna the proceeds of his next album, which becomes <i>Here, My Dear</i> (1978)
Exile between worlds	Bankruptcy, then exile in Europe, ending in Ostend, Belgium (1981)

C. Full Film Sheet (Memo #008)

1. Title: *Trouble Man*

It's the title of Marvin's 1972 soundtrack and single, and a fitting name for the darker chapter. To the public, it's a song title (Memo #007).

2. What's Being Adapted

Source	Used for
Primary: David Ritz, <i>Divided Soul</i> (1985)	Marvin's 1970s, the divorce and the exile
Jan Gaye's firsthand account (later published as <i>After the Dance</i> , 2015)	The Marvin–Jan relationship, told from her side
The master recordings, label credits, the Billboard chart record, and court and settlement records	Every song, credit and chart position, plus the divorce terms

3. What the Movie Is About

Logline: On top of the world after *What's Going On*, Motown's prince falls into a darker decade of desire, debt and divorce, and ends up paying his ex-wife with his own music.

Act One: On Top (1971–1974). The *Trouble Man* soundtrack (1972). “Let's Get It On” goes to #1 (1973), and he records duets with Diana Ross. He meets Janis Hunter in 1973, when she was 17. They marry in 1977, and the film handles this carefully and exactly as documented. His first live shows in years follow (1974).

Act Two: The Darkness (1975–1978). His marriage to Anna ends, and the royal family splits. “Got to Give It Up” reaches #1 (1977) while drugs and debt pile up. The divorce settlement signs over the proceeds of his next album, and he turns that album into *Here, My Dear* (1978), a double album about the marriage.

Act Three: Exile (1979–1981). He goes bankrupt, leaves for Hawaii and then Europe, and in 1981 lands in Ostend, Belgium, broke, clean for now, and writing again.

4. Whose Movie / Franchise It Is

Marvin Gaye's. This is his second solo film, with him at full strength (No-Nerf): the talent and the self-destruction, both as documented.

5. Antagonist

Level	Antagonist	What the record supports
Primary	Cocaine and debt	The dark force spreading through his life, like the Dark Elves.
Secondary	The divorce	A real legal and emotional battle with Anna Gordy Gaye. Both sides are portrayed as documented, and neither is a villain.
Internal	Marvin's own self-destruction	The same division inside him that <i>What's Going On</i> hinted at.

6. Timeline: When & Where

	Setting
When	1971 to 1981. The fixed points are the <i>Trouble Man</i> soundtrack (1972), “Let's Get It On” at #1 (1973), “Got to Give It Up” at #1 (1977), <i>Here, My Dear</i> (Dec. 1978), and Ostend (1981).
Where	Los Angeles (Motown's new home), concert stages, Hawaii, London, and Ostend, Belgium.
Master timeline	TMU Chapter Seven. It picks up where <i>What's Going On</i> ends (May 1971).

7. Standalone World-Building

Marvin's 1970s: Los Angeles, fame, his new love, the divorce, and exile in Europe. The story is complete from peak to fall to a fragile peace.

8. Motown Universe World-Building

Type	Established in <i>Trouble Man</i>
Returning	Marvin (the same actor since <i>Hitsville</i>), Anna Gordy, Berry Gordy and Diana Ross (the duets), and Frankie Gaye.
Crossover	The Marvin–Diana duet sessions (1973) link this film to Diana's thread in <i>Hitsville 3</i> . Motown's Los Angeles headquarters appears as a shared setting.
Plot elements	Money and control, the long-running threat planted in <i>The Motortown Revue</i> (Memo #015), hits the royal family itself.

9. Post-Credits Scenes: Two

Scene	What happens
Mid-credits (Gary, Indiana, July 1968)	Singer Bobby Taylor drives five brothers from a steel town to Detroit for a Motown audition. It sets up <i>I Want You Back</i> , just as <i>The Dark World's</i> Collector scene set up <i>Guardians</i> .
End-credits (Ostend, 1981)	Marvin sits alone at a keyboard by the North Sea and starts working out a new song. The prince hasn't given up.

10. How It Kicks Everything Off

N/A. This field is for the first film only (Memo #008).

Compliance Check

Mandate	Status
Fidelity (Memo #001)	PASS. Every event, song, credit and date comes from the documented record.
No-Nerf (Memo #001)	PASS. Every character appears at full documented strength.
Studio (Memos #002–#003)	PASS. Motown Productions, distributed by Paramount.
Phase (Memo #004)	PASS. Phase 2, Film 2 of 6. Released November 7, 2014.
Story model (Memo #005)	PASS. 60% serialized / 40% standalone (Phase 2 target).
Format (Memo #005)	PASS. Musical Biographical Drama, PG-13, approx. 155 min.
Continuity (Memo #005)	PASS. The same Marvin actor returns, the Ross duet sessions match her thread, and the dates follow straight on from Film 4.
Secrecy (Memo #007)	PASS. Publicly marketed as a Marvin Gaye biopic sequel, with no universe branding.

TMU is a fan-made alternate-reality concept. It has no connection to Motown Records, Universal, Paramount or Marvel Studios. The people named are real. The films and the roles here are fictional.